

Introduction to Scratch

Learning Objectives

- Understand what Scratch is and its purpose
- Navigate the Scratch interface and identify key areas
- Create a simple project with a sprite and backdrop

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Imagine you have a puppet show at a village mela. You control the puppets, make them move, speak, and dance. Scratch is like a digital puppet theatre on the computer—you tell the characters what to do using colorful blocks instead of strings. Let us explore this fun tool today.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Open Scratch on the computer. Look at the stage area, the sprite list, and the block palette. Click on different blocks and see what happens when you drag them together. Try making the cat sprite move by attaching a “move 10 steps” block to a “when green flag clicked” block.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Scratch is a free programming language developed by MIT for young learners. The interface has a stage where your project runs, sprites which are characters, and blocks which are instructions you snap together. Programs in Scratch are called projects and you save them as .sb3 files.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Think of Scratch like arranging blocks to build a house—each block has a specific job. Now create a project where your sprite moves across the stage. Add a backdrop of a village scene and make the sprite say “Namaste” when clicked. Experiment by adding more blocks.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Name three parts of the Scratch interface and explain what a sprite is. Draw the Scratch screen from memory and label the stage, block palette, and script area.